Jacques Groenewald

HEAD OF DIGITAL MARKETING

Paid Media, Performance Marketing, Marketing Operations and Analytics | B2B and eCommerce

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PROFILE

18 years in commercial roles, 11 leading digital marketing since 2015. Digital marketing leader who runs the whole channel mix and holds it to revenue: paid search and social, LinkedIn, SEO, email and lifecycle, websites and conversion, and the tracking that proves what worked. For three years I ran digital as **fractional Head of Digital Marketing for Ensinger UK**, reporting to the MD across three brands. Earlier, I managed **Microsoft's MSN and Skype advertising portfolio for Africa and the Middle East ($1.5M a month)** at Mediamark, and ran an agency team of 10 managing **R300,000 a month in Google and Facebook ad spend** for 40+ accounts.

I have also built two brands of my own from zero to R900,000+ in sales each, so I judge channels on contribution margin and store-measured revenue, not platform-reported numbers. I diagnose from data first, then build hands-on: campaigns, creative tests, tracking, CRM, automation and AI agents. I am winding down my consulting practice to give one full-time remote leadership role my full attention.

KEY RESULTS

- **Cost per lead cut 77%** (£69 to £16) on LinkedIn for Ensinger UK, with 43 leads in 30 days.
- **Record month of R136,000 at 3.6x blended ROAS** after rebuilding an owned brand's Meta account, measured against store revenue rather than the 2.05x the platform reported.
- **Contact actions up 53%** for Ensinger UK through LinkedIn and Google Search; LinkedIn video **CTR from 1.09% to 2.0%** and cost per result from £2.50 to £1.30.
- **949 leads in 60 days at $4.78**, and **550+ registrations and 300 attendees** for investor events in China, New York and South Africa.
- **Lead response for a travel franchise:** every lead answered in **under a minute** and quote preparation cut from an hour to **2 minutes**; 230 enquiries became 219 quotes and R322,000 in bookings in 30 days, at about R32 per lead.

EXPERIENCE

FOUNDER-DIRECTOR, DIGITAL MARKETING AND GROWTH

Jan 2015 - Present

JCE Media (Duel Digital (Pty) Ltd), Johannesburg | Digital marketing consultancy, plus owned brands

2015 to 2020, as Duel Digital: built and led an in-house agency team of 10 (four salespeople, a designer, a developer, a media buyer, a social media manager and an executive assistant), hired every role myself, designed the sales comp plans and set the team's SLAs. We ran marketing for 40+ SMB accounts, managed **R300,000 a month in Google and Facebook ad spend**, built **400+ websites** and ran in-store activations and competitions. **2020 onwards, as JCE Media:** when Covid hit, pivoted from agency to consultancy for international clients in B2B SaaS, travel tech, manufacturing, proptech, services and eCommerce (UK, US, South Africa), with a core team of an operations lead and a sales partner, plus specialist contractors.

- Created the **Seven Figure Blueprint**, a productised three-week strategy engagement (diagnostic, ICPs, channel plan, money model, 90-day plan), and ran it for **25+ companies** including AeroCRS, WorldTicket, Ensinger UK and Club 720.
- Ran **paid media across Google, Meta and LinkedIn** for B2B and eCommerce clients, with structured creative testing and conversion tracking rebuilt in GA4 and Google Tag Manager; outbound for a travel-tech SaaS (AeroCRS) reached a **60% reply rate**, with 54% of replies booking a demo.
- Rescued an eCommerce client's **organic search after a site migration**: mapped and verified 590 redirects covering 65.6% of revenue-bearing URLs, rebuilt on-site search and fixed site speed.
- Designed **CRM, email and lifecycle** journeys in GoHighLevel, HubSpot, Pipedrive and Klaviyo: a six-location US salon group (22-email nurture), a travel franchise's WhatsApp bot and follow-up, and as fractional Head of Marketing Operations for Dynamic Language, a Pipedrive build that lifted **MQL to SQL conversion 35%**.
- Ran **data diagnostics**: a five-year cohort analysis (1,184 orders) showed new-customer 90-day repeat rate falling from 38.7% to 12.3%, a R113,000-a-year leak, and set the retention fixes.
- Built the business's own **marketing operating system**: reporting, content and ad production pipelines, and 25+ AI agent workflows (Claude Code, Make.com).

REVIEWTAP *| Review-collection hardware and software (owned brand) | 2024 - Present*

- Built the go-to-market from zero: positioning, pricing, Shopify store, paid acquisition, CRM follow-up and onboarding. **R930,000+ revenue in its first 18 months**.
- Rebuilt the Meta account into prospecting, retargeting and creative testing for a **record R136,000 month at 3.6x blended ROAS**; ran Google Search and AI-generated video ad production alongside it.

MYFOREVERBABY *| Consumer eCommerce (owned brand) | 2025 - Present*

- **R919,000 gross sales in the first 14 months**, peak month R172,000, owning the P&L, Meta acquisition, Shopify conversion and email.

- Ran a controlled ad audit against first-touch store data: simple ads cost R809 per purchase at 4.35x ROAS against R1,059 at 2.23x for automated variants, and reset the account on that finding.

FRACTIONAL HEAD OF DIGITAL MARKETING

Jun 2022 - Nov 2025

Ensinger UK (engineering plastics manufacturer), via JCE Media | Remote

- Turned a 2022 Seven Figure Blueprint into a three-year role running digital for Ensinger, Elekem and Insulbar, reporting to the MD, and wrote the annual plan and report.
- Lifted contact actions **53%** (Contact Us clicks up 61%, enquiry forms up 20%) through LinkedIn and Google Search.
- A/B tested LinkedIn video ads: **CTR from 1.09% to 2.0%**, **cost per result from £2.50 to £1.30**.
- Built ABM outbound in Lemlist (1,240 invites, 5.5% reply rate), grew LinkedIn followers 32% and engagement 58% in a year, set up GA4 and Tag Manager, and handed the function in-house in Nov 2025.

FRACTIONAL HEAD OF MARKETING

Jun 2022 - Mar 2025

Club 720 and Your Housing Resource (US homeownership platform), via JCE Media | Remote

- Led digital across paid search and social, email, webinars and partner outreach.
- Reached **1,717 active users and 69 home buyer applications** in a 30-day period, with paid search driving most new users.

PORTFOLIO MANAGER, MICROSOFT MSN AND SKYPE

Jan 2012 - Dec 2014

Mediamark (media sales house) | Africa and Middle East

- Managed Microsoft's MSN and Skype advertising portfolio for Africa and the Middle East, **worth $1.5M a month**, as commercial lead for advertisers and their agencies; grew **net revenue retention from existing clients year on year**.
- Sold and managed digital campaigns for Vodacom, Unilever, Standard Bank, Absa, Outsurance and First for Women through Omnicom and GroupM, including the **Vodacom Durban July (R5M+)**.
- Ran cross-platform campaigns that extended to radio (Gagasi FM, Jacaranda FM, East Coast Radio), and was part of the launch of **Adfu**, Mediamark's programmatic media platform.
- Won the Hard Drive Award for top performer **five months in a row**.

SALES MANAGER

Jan 2009 - Dec 2011

Planet Fitness, Craighall and Rosebank, Johannesburg

- Hired, trained and led sales teams of up to 20 consultants across two clubs, with territory planning and forecasting; both clubs ranked among the **top 5 clubs in the country**.

SKILLS

DIGITAL MARKETING:	digital strategy and budgets, paid search and paid social (Google, Meta, LinkedIn), programmatic, A/B and creative testing, SEO and site migrations, content and social, email and lifecycle, CRO and landing pages, ABM and outbound, GA4 and conversion tracking, attribution, reporting and dashboards, agency and team leadership.
PLATFORMS:	Google Ads, Meta Ads, LinkedIn Ads, Google Analytics 4, Google Tag Manager, Search Console, Microsoft Clarity, HubSpot, Salesforce (reporting data), Pipedrive, GoHighLevel, Klaviyo, Lemlist, Shopify, WordPress and WooCommerce.
TOOLS:	Make.com, Zapier, n8n, Claude Code and AI agents, AI image and video generation, Python for data work; Microsoft Excel, PowerPoint and Power BI (advanced).

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

BCom Management and Economics (incomplete: two modules outstanding, re-enrolling 2027), Central University of Technology.

HubSpot certified: Digital Marketing (Oct 2026), Revenue Operations (Nov 2026). **OpenAI Academy** (Oct 2026): AI Foundations, AI Leadership, Agentic Systems, AI Application Performance. **Anthropic Claude Academy** (Oct 2026): AI Fluency Framework and Foundations, AI Fluency for Builders, AI Fluency for Creative Work, Deploying Claude Enterprise, Building Effective Human-Agent Teams. South African citizen, available now (UK, EU, US East Coast hours). References: Mediamark line manager; Ensinger UK's MD.